

Module 0 — Intro & Setup

Lesson 0.1

Course overview

What you'll learn, how to read it, and how to know if this course is for you.

Mastering Claude Code — An E-Course for Power Users

Why it matters

Most teams adopt Claude Code in a vibes-based way: install it, type things, hope. That works for toy tasks. It falls apart the moment you try to drive serious work through it — multi-file refactors, debugging production code, long-running automation, team-wide standards.

This course is the opposite: deliberate practice with the tools, settings, and patterns that actually compound.

The mental model

Think of Claude Code as a programmable shell that happens to have a model behind it. Everything that makes it powerful is configurable:

- **Memory** — `CLAUDE.md` files and the auto-memory system
- **Permissions** — what tools/commands Claude can run without asking
- **Hooks** — shell commands triggered by lifecycle events
- **Slash commands** — your own commands, written in markdown
- **Subagents** — focused workers with their own context window
- **MCP servers** — protocol-level extensions exposing tools, data, and prompts
- **SDK** — headless programmatic agents for cron jobs, CI, scripts

A power user shapes all of these to their workflow. By the end of the course, you should be doing the same.

How the course is structured

Nine modules, each with 3–6 lessons. Every lesson follows the same shape so you can skim:

- 1 **One-line summary** at top
- 2 **Why it matters**
- 3 **The mental model**
- 4 **The mechanics** (commands, configs, code)
- 5 **Try it** (hands-on exercise)
- 6 **Gotchas**
- 7 **Further reading**

Lessons link to runnable demos in examples/. Read at a desk, type along.

Pacing

If you have...	Do this
One evening	Modules 0–1
One weekend	Modules 0–3
One week, 1 hr/night	Whole course in order
Specific need	Jump to the relevant module via SYLLABUS

What we assume you already know

- Comfortable with a Unix-like shell (bash/zsh/PowerShell+wsl)
- Comfortable with git, including branches, rebases, and PRs
- You've used at least one LLM coding tool (Copilot, Cursor, Claude.ai, etc.) — you don't need to be expert, just not surprised by autocomplete-style suggestions
- You can write a config file in JSON without panicking

If any of these is a stretch, you can still take the course — just expect to slow down in places.

What we explicitly do NOT cover

- Claude.ai web chat (this is Code-specific)
- Prompt engineering as a general topic (we touch on it only where it affects Code workflows)
- General LLM theory — no transformer diagrams, no token economics beyond the practical

How to get help while taking the course

- `claude --help` and `/help` are the source of truth for your installed version.
- The [official Claude Code docs](#) cover everything we reference and more.
- Issues and feature requests: <https://github.com/anthropics/claude-code/issues>

Next

→ 0.2 Setup & sanity check